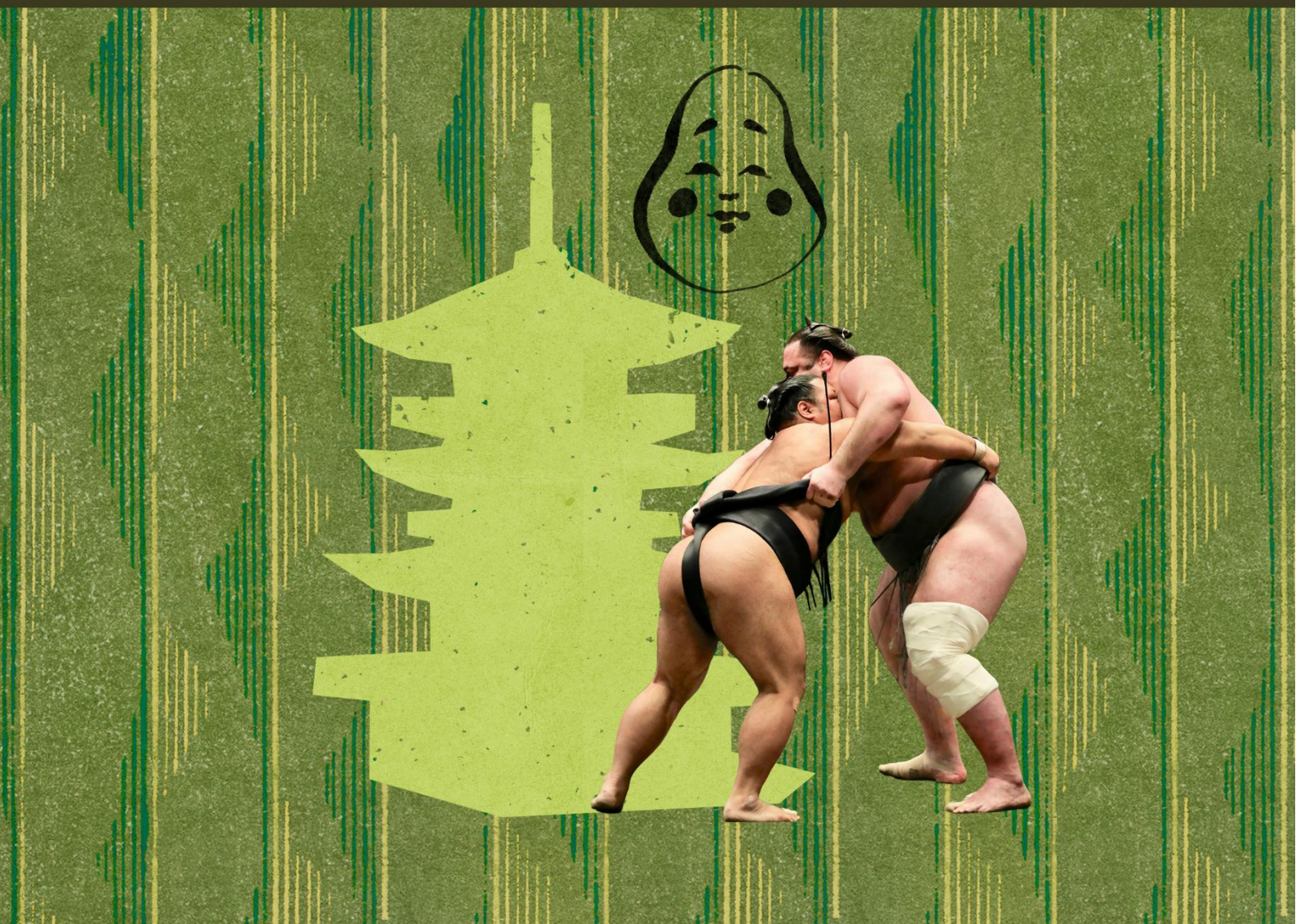
INSIDE JAPAN

Your Proposal

Japan adventures,
perfected by people



Your Proposal Document

ART, CULTURE AND HIKING IN JAPAN II 4
PRICE DETAILS 8
ACCOMMODATION 31
VISA INFORMATION 34
WHAT'S INCLUDED 35

Your Japan Travel Expert

Emma Mckeag

Email: emma.mckeag@insidejapantours.com

Emma became interested in Japan during her final years of high school, during which she travelled throughout the island of Honshu on a language exchange trip, as well as hosting Japanese students at home in the UK (in lovely Suffolk). Every day since the trip she looked forward to returning and from 2018-2019 studied in Tokyo as part of a BA Japanese degree. She loves travelling both in Japan and around the world, getting to know new cultures, histories, languages and people. A big food lover, she also enjoys trying the huge range of speciality dishes from across Japan's regions.



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Art, Culture and Hiking in Japan II

Mrs Myrna Higgins

Quote Date: 19 March 2026

Quote Reference: 1266818

Consultant: Emma Mckeag

Passengers

Mrs Myrna Higgins
Mr Joe Higgins

Itinerary in brief

Sunday 01 Nov 2026

Day 1
- Flight BA5 from London Heathrow to Haneda Airport Dep. 11:45 Arr. 10:25 + 1

Overnight onboard the aircraft

Monday 02 Nov 2026

Day 2
- Flight BA5 arrives at Haneda Airport 10:25
- Shared Shuttle Bus from Haneda Airport to Tokyo Hotel
- Mobile WiFi Device

Tokyo | Mitsui Garden Hotel Jingugaien Tokyo Premier

Tuesday 03 Nov 2026

Day 3
- Tokyo Sightseeing - East Central Tokyo

Tokyo | Mitsui Garden Hotel Jingugaien Tokyo Premier

Wednesday 04 Nov 2026

Day 4
- Tokyo Sightseeing - West Central Tokyo

Tokyo | Mitsui Garden Hotel Jingugaien Tokyo Premier

Thursday 05 Nov 2026

Day 5
- Hike Mount Takao (3 Hours)

Tokyo | Mitsui Garden Hotel Jingugaien Tokyo Premier

Friday 06 Nov 2026

Day 6

- Transfer by train from Tokyo (Shinjuku) to Matsumoto
- Matsumoto Castle & Castle District

Matsumoto | Matsumoto Hotel Kagetsu

Saturday 07 Nov 2026

Day 7

- Luggage Forwarding (not incl.)
- Transfer by train from Matsumoto to Yabuhara
- Nakasendo Walk from Yabuhara to Narai (6.5km, 3 Hours)

Narai | Echigoya

Sunday 08 Nov 2026

Day 8

- Transfer by train from Narai to Nagiso
- Nakasendo Walk from Nagiso to Tsumago (1 Hour)

Tsumago | Daikichi

Monday 09 Nov 2026

Day 9

- Nakasendo Walk from Tsumago to Magome (8km, 3 Hours)
- Bus from Magome to Nakatsugawa
- Trains From Nakatsugawa To Kyoto

Kyoto | Solaria Nishitetsu Hotel Kyoto Premier

Tuesday 10 Nov 2026

Day 10

- Full Day Private Guide Service in Kyoto

Kyoto | Solaria Nishitetsu Hotel Kyoto Premier

Wednesday 11 Nov 2026

Day 11

- Arts and Crafts in Kyoto

Kyoto | Solaria Nishitetsu Hotel Kyoto Premier

Thursday 12 Nov 2026

Day 12
- Suggested Sightseeing - Alternative Arashiyama

Kyoto | Solaria Nishitetsu Hotel Kyoto Premier

Friday 13 Nov 2026

Day 13
- Optional Day Trip to Nara

Kyoto | Solaria Nishitetsu Hotel Kyoto Premier

Saturday 14 Nov 2026

Day 14
- Trains from Kyoto to Takamatsu
- Ritsurin Garden in Takamatsu

Takamatsu | Royal Park Hotel Takamatsu

Sunday 15 Nov 2026

Day 15
- Ferry from Takamatsu to Naoshima (Miyanoura Port)
- Bike Rental on Naoshima (reservation only)
- Sightseeing on Naoshima
- Chichu Art Museum
- Ferry from Naoshima (Miyanoura Port) to Takamatsu

Takamatsu | Royal Park Hotel Takamatsu

Monday 16 Nov 2026

Day 16
- Ferry from Takamatsu to Teshima (Ieura Port)
- Teshima Art Museum
- Sightseeing on Teshima
- Ferry from Teshima (Ieura Port) to Takamatsu

Takamatsu | Royal Park Hotel Takamatsu

Tuesday 17 Nov 2026

Day 17
- Trains from Takamatsu to Tokyo
- Local train journey in Tokyo

Tokyo | Asakusa View Hotel Annex Rokku

Wednesday 18 Nov 2026

Day 18	• Sightseeing in Tokyo

Tokyo | Asakusa View Hotel Annex Rokku

Thursday 19 Nov 2026

Day 19	• Shared Shuttle Bus from Hotel to Tokyo Haneda Airport • Flight BA6 from Haneda Airport to London Heathrow Dep. 13:15 Arr. 19:10

Price Details

The price for the arrangements included in this proposal is:

Total price: GBP £12,690.00

£6,345.00 per person

Deposit due: £1,904.00

The price for the ground arrangements quoted is valid for 7 days from 19 March 2026 and is subject to availability.

International flights are included in your package. They are not currently held, and the price is subject to availability at the time of confirmation. If you would like us to hold the flights, please let us know including your full names and dates of birth as per passports.

The deposit is non-refundable. As soon as your deposit is received, we will get to work confirming all the arrangements for your trip. As our trips involve lots of elements booked with different partners, so it can take some time to get everything confirmed. We aim to send out your full confirmation within 10 working days.

Full terms and conditions can be found here.

Financial protection

Your cultural adventure is fully financially protected by the ATOL scheme. We hold an Air Travel Organiser's License (9419) issued by the Civil Aviation Authority. You can book with confidence knowing your money is safe and that you'll be looked after if anything goes wrong including any included flights. You'll receive an ATOL certificate on confirmation of your booking and you can read more about the ATOL scheme here.

Love what you see?

Secure your trip today by paying your deposit. Our team will get to work immediately on confirming these arrangements.

Refine your itinerary

Want to tweak or try swapping something in? Let us know any questions or changes and we'll keep working on it until it's exactly what you want.

Ready to book your trip?

Your quote number is 1266818.

The easiest way to pay your deposit and manage your booking is via our client portal at https://mytrip.insidetravelgroup.com/

If you would prefer to pay over the phone, please give me a call on UK (0)117 992 7052. We also accept payment by bank transfer.

What happens next?

Once your deposit is paid, you can sit back, relax and let us do all the hard work.



We lock in your trip details

Our team starts securing your accommodation, experiences, and transport – ensuring everything is locked in and tailored to your preferences. Once this is completed, we'll send your confirmation documents (within 10 working days).



Pre-departure support

Whether your trip departs in one month or one year from now, we're here for you at any point. From packing advice to cultural tips and our top Insider recommendations, just let us know how we can help make your cultural adventure what you want it to be.



Receive your Info-Pack

Three weeks before you travel, your personalised Info-Pack will be ready. It's packed with everything you'll need to know for a smooth, stress-free cultural adventure. From your detailed day-by-day itinerary to language tips and Insider picks.



In destination support

Once you leave home, our 24/7 customer experience team are available for anything you might need. From last-minute questions to unexpected changes, we'll make sure everything runs perfectly so you can focus on enjoying every moment.

Getting there

International flights are included in your package. They are not currently held, and the price is subject to availability at the time of confirmation. If you would like us to hold the flights, please let us know including your full names and dates of birth as per passports.

Flight BA5

British Airways

DEPARTURE	ARRIVAL
London	**Tokyo**
01 Nov 2026 at 11:45	02 Nov 2026 at 10:25
(LHR), United Kingdom	(HND), Japan
London Heathrow	Haneda Airport

Passengers	Class
Mrs Myrna Higgins	Economy
Mr Joe Higgins	Economy

Flight BA6

British Airways

DEPARTURE	ARRIVAL
Tokyo	**London**
19 Nov 2026 at 13:15	19 Nov 2026 at 19:10
(HND), Japan	(LHR), United Kingdom
Haneda Airport	London Heathrow

Passengers	Class
Mrs Myrna Higgins	Economy
Mr Joe Higgins	Economy

Detailed day-by-day

Day 1
Sunday
01 Nov

Flight BA5 from London Heathrow to Haneda Airport Dep. 11:45 Arr. 10:25 + 1

Depart London Heathrow on flight BA5 to Haneda Airport. The flight departs at 11:45 and arrives at 10:25 the following day.

Overnight on board the aircraft

Day 2
Monday
02 Nov

Shared Shuttle Bus from Haneda Airport to Tokyo Hotel

Welcome to Japan! You will be met on arrival at Tokyo Haneda Airport today and taken by shuttle bus to your hotel in Tokyo. Please note that as other people will be in the same bus there may be a few stops before you arrive at your hotel (maximum of 3 other stops). Journey time is around an hour and this is a comfortable and easy way to make today's transfer. Look out for some great views as you ride the elevated highways into town.

Seat - Shared Service (2)

Mobile WiFi Device

We have included for you the rental of a mobile WiFi device which we will arrange to be delivered to your first hotel. This will mean that you can have unlimited WiFi data on the move and at all of your accommodation making staying in touch with friends or browsing the internet on your smartphone or laptop a breeze. The WiFi can be shared between up to 10 devices. We have included full insurance for you in case of damage or loss. Your device is a Softbank Wifi device with unlimited data. At the end of your stay simply return the device in the pre-paid envelope provided.

18 Day Rental (Incl. Delivery & Full Insurance) - Softbank (unlimited data)

Tokyo - Introduction





A quarter of the Japanese population live in Tokyo or the near vicinity and with a population of over 12 million inhabitants, Tokyo is one of the largest cities in the world. With its huge skyscrapers, underpasses, overpasses and crowds of pedestrians, Tokyo may not seem the most attractive city on the surface, but the city has a vibrant charm all of its own. The street level detail is what makes Tokyo such an incredibly interesting place to explore and at every turn you will be met with an array of sights, sounds and smells to enliven the senses. The city has many major sights to visit such as Senso-ji Temple in the old downtown area of Asakusa or the fashion hub of Shibuya from where all new trends are said to emanate. All in all a stay in Tokyo is to experience one of the world's most vibrant and interesting cities; a capital hurtling headlong into the future whilst maintaining its links with the traditions of ancient Japan.

Overnight at Mitsui Garden Hotel Jingugaien Tokyo Premier • 1 x Double - Incl. Breakfast

Day 3
Tuesday
03 Nov

Tokyo Sightseeing - East Central Tokyo

Today you have a free day to explore Tokyo. As the city is vast, it can be best to split your time amongst certain districts.

Many a Tokyo visit begins in Asakusa, a popular neighbourhood home to the temple complex of Sensouji. Here, you can experience Japanese Buddhism in the middle of one of the world's biggest cities. You can pass through the impressively named 'Kaminarimon', or Thunder Gate, to walk up the busy 'Nakamise' street leading to the temple. The Nakamise is lined with souvenir stalls, food stands and other shops hoping to catch your eye. As the area is so busy, we generally recommend visiting in the evening or at night – the temple grounds are still visitable but will have far fewer people around. If you're staying in Asakusa itself, this is definitely the best way to enjoy the impressive architecture.

Asakusa borders the Sumida river, and water buses run across the day. From Asakusa Nitenmon Terminal, you can board a boat to Ryogoku – home to Tokyo's sumo. During the sumo 'basho' (tournament) months, the area will be busy with those attending the matches at the Kokugikan. Outside of the Tokyo 'basho', you may find sumo enjoying some down time after an intense morning training – they're not guaranteed but also hard to miss.

After Ryogoku, you may wish to hop on the Tokyo metro to Tsukiji, the site of the old Fish Market. Although the morning tuna auctions have moved to Toyosu, Tsukiji is still home to numerous fishmongers and other produce shops if you're looking for some lunch. A short walk from Tsukiji is the famous Hamarikyu Gardens – these gardens are a moment of serenity in the middle of Tokyo; a traditional setting flanked by skyscrapers and 5* hotels. The gardens are home to a teahouse where you can enjoy a quiet moment, some fresh matcha and a traditional sweet after a day of exploration



Overnight at Mitsui Garden Hotel Jingugaien Tokyo Premier • 1 x Double - Incl. Breakfast

Day 4
Wednesday
04 Nov

Tokyo Sightseeing - West Central Tokyo

Today you have a free day to explore Tokyo. As the city is vast, it can be best to split your time amongst certain districts. In Western central Tokyo, you can find the bright, modern and iconic side of Japan that is known around the world. The bright lights and nightlife of Shinjuku, the bustle of Shibuya and the fashion hotspot of Harajuku and Omotesando.

Shinjuku has always had a reputation as one of Tokyo's pleasure quarters. In times gone by, it was the first post town outside the city proper and had a reputation for licentiousness. In the early decades of this century it became a haven for bohemian artists, writers, and students. Today, Shinjuku is seemingly conjured from a retro sci-fi comic book. A quick cut sequence of cinematic images, this is a district that dares to display everything: from dazzlingly modern skyscrapers and an opera district, to rinky-dink booze stalls in back alleys where the communal rest rooms don't have locks on the doors - all on the same stretch of pavement.

A short stop away on the Yamanote circular line is Shibuya, famous for its busy road crossing outside the station. Shibuya is a hub for local fashion and shopping, and it's a popular spot for tourists and local alike. If you want an amazing view of Tokyo, you can head to the Shibuya Sky observatory, although be aware that you will need to reserve tickets in advance – it's very popular!

Another hop away you'll find Harajuku. It had its heyday in the late 90s and early 21st century as a fashion mecca for the weird and wonderful – bright bursts of colour and 'kawaii' cute fashion all became popular here. Fashion has spread around the city these days, but the main street of Takeshita-dori is still an exciting blur of colour and excitement to explore, with independent fashion shops, crepe stands and boyband

memorabilia stores lining the streets. In the same neighbourhood, you'll find Omotesando; a more 'evergreen' fashion district home to all of the high-end brands. Many of the stores have fascinating architecture that can be appreciated without spending all of your money. Once you're ready to relax, a gentle stroll through Yoyogi Park next to Harajuku may be in order – the home of Meiji Shrine.



Overnight at Mitsui Garden Hotel Jingugaien Tokyo Premier • 1 x Double - Incl. Breakfast

Day 5
Thursday
05 Nov

Hike Mount Takao (3 Hours)

If you find that after a while Tokyo's concrete and neon get you yearning for countryside, fresh air and scenery then you can do no better than a day trip out west to sacred Mount Takao (Takao-san in Japanese), part of a range of wooded mountains that form a natural boundary to Tokyo's urban sprawl and mark the start of the Chichibu-Tama National Park. After an easy train journey of just under an hour you will arrive at the base of the mountain from where numerous clearly-marked hiking trails (or a cable-car!) wind their way up to the summit. Many of the routes offer fine views back towards Tokyo and are dotted with small temples, religious statues and offerings increasing in number as the trails approach Yakuoin, an attractive temple dedicated to the 'kami' or spirits of the mountains. On a clear day you can also enjoy some great views of Mount Fuji. The hike to the summit of Takao-san can be done in 2-3 hours and is of only moderate difficulty. For those wanting a further challenge there are a number of more advanced hiking routes that head on from the summit of Mount Takao to other peaks deeper into the National Park. Again these are clearly marked and can be combined with the hike up Mount Takao to form a full day of more advanced hiking. Although popular with Japanese hikers, Mount Takao is virtually untouched by overseas visitors to Japan, so if you like the idea of getting off the beaten track then this might just be the day trip for you!



Overnight at Mitsui Garden Hotel Jingugaien Tokyo Premier • 1 x Double - Incl. Breakfast

Day 6
Friday
06 Nov

Transfer by train from Tokyo (Shinjuku) to Matsumoto

The direct express train to Matsumoto leaves from Tokyo's Shinjuku Station (the world's busiest with nearly 3 million passengers a day passing through the ticket barriers). Journey time is in the region of 2 hours 30 minutes as the train takes you out through the suburbs of Tokyo before you reach the open countryside with paddy fields, rivers, lakes and of course, the steep-sided peaks of the Japanese Alps.We will be supplying you with Limited Express Ordinary tickets for this journey. If the weather is

clear, be sure to keep an eye open for Mount Fuji from the left hand windows of the train as you travel through Tokyo's outer suburbs.
Limited Express - Ordinary (2)

Matsumoto - Introduction





Matsumoto is an alpine city surrounded on all sides by the towering peaks of the Japan Alps and has an almost European feel to it. The city is most famous for its original castle which is only a short distance from the station. This is one of the only original castles in Japan and really gives you a sense of ancient Japan and how the samurai used to live and fight. The city also boasts a number of sake breweries, hidden in the backstreets amongst the traditional buildings, a good museum of Ukiyoe woodblock prints, and is the home of soba noodles, the local speciality which is particularly delicious. You can also try some of the city's other local delicacy - raw horse! The city has a really relaxed atmosphere and a cosmopolitan feel befitting of a city renowned for its musicians and authors. The famous violin teacher, Suzuki (of the Suzuki method) originated from Matsumoto and you will find a commemorative statue on the street opposite the station.

Matsumoto Castle & Castle District

Step into the world of samurai at Matsumoto Castle, one of Japan’s few original castles and a designated National Treasure. Built in the late 1500s and known as the “Black Crow” for its striking dark wooden walls, the castle offers a rare chance to experience authentic Japanese history. Inside, you’ll climb steep wooden staircases and duck under low beams—just as samurai once did—before reaching the top floor, where panoramic views of the city and the Japanese Alps await.

To make the most of your visit, plan to arrive early in the morning or later in the afternoon, especially during summer and cherry blossom season, when the castle is at its busiest. Weekdays are generally quieter than weekends, and heading straight to the main keep before exploring the grounds can help you enjoy the castle at its most peaceful. The surrounding moat and gardens are especially beautiful in spring and autumn, and you might even spot volunteers dressed as samurai or ninja, ready to share stories and pose for photos.

Right outside the castle, you'll find Nakamachi Street—a historic merchant district lined with white-walled storehouses now home to cafés, galleries, and craft shops. Just across the river, Nawate-dori ("Frog Street") offers quirky statues, snack stalls, and a taste of local life. If you're interested in art, the Matsumoto City Museum of Art is a short walk away and features bold installations by Yayoi Kusama, one of Japan's most celebrated contemporary artists. And when you're ready for a break, local soba restaurants serve up Shinshu buckwheat noodles—a simple, delicious way to round out your day of discovery.

A visit to Matsumoto Castle isn't just about seeing a famous landmark—it's a chance to step into living history, explore a vibrant neighbourhood, and experience the best of Matsumoto's culture and hospitality, all within easy walking distance.



Overnight at Matsumoto Hotel Kagetsu • 1 x Standard Twin (Main Building) (24sqm) - Incl. B'fast

Day 7
Saturday
07 Nov

Luggage Forwarding (not incl.)

Today you will be travelling to Tsumago in the Kiso Valley. Large pieces of luggage will be an inconvenience to you while you are walking the Nakasendo Way. In addition there is limited luggage space at your accommodation in the region. We highly recommend forwarding the bulk of your luggage from Matsumoto to your Kyoto accommodation, and travelling light with small overnight bags to the Kiso Valley.

Transfer by train from Matsumoto to Yabuhara

Today you will take a local line train from Matsumoto to Yabuhara in the Kiso Valley. Journey time is 1 hour and there are some lovely views en-route.
Fare Ticket - Ordinary (2)

Nakasendo Walk from Yabuhara to Narai (6.5km, 3 Hours)

Yabuhara Station is the starting point of the 6.5km trail up and over the Torii Pass. This is one of the highest sections of the old Nakasendo Way and will see you walking from 900 to 1,200m above sea level before dropping down into Narai. Along the way you'll hike through larch forests, past little mountain shrines and an old teahouse rest stop. As you descend, there are lovely views across Narai, another well-preserved post town. The hike usually takes 2.5 to 3 hours.

Narai - Introduction





Narai, sometimes referred to as "Narai of a thousand houses", was once the wealthiest town on the Nakasendo Way as it marked the halfway point between Kyoto and Edo (Tokyo). The heart of the town is a 1km long stretch of road lined with beautifully preserved wooden buildings complete with traditional renji-goshi lattice work. Some of these buildings are ryokan inns, while others are former merchant residences now open to the public.

Overnight at Echigoya • 1 x Twin Use (Japanese Style) - Without Bathroom (Incl. Breakfast & Dinner)

Day 8

Sunday
08 Nov

Transfer by train from Narai to Nagiso

From Narai you will take a local line train on to Nagiso Station further down the Kiso Valley. Journey time is just over one hour.
Fare Ticket - Ordinary (2)

Nakasendo Walk from Nagiso to Tsumago (1 Hour)

Like the Cotswolds in England, the walk through the Kiso Valley is simply charming; the perfect place for a relaxed wander, taking photos of quaint Japanese buildings, popping into craftshops and saying konnichiwa to the friendly locals you'll meet en-route. From Nagiso train station you can follow the Nakasendo Way - an ancient samurai trail - through the Kiso Valley to the village of Tsumago. The walk takes around an hour, and full details will be in your Info-Pack. If it's raining or you don't fancy the walk, we'll also provide details of taxi and bus services.

Tsumago - Introduction





Tsumago, the jewel of the Kiso Valley, was once a post town on the old Nakasendo highway linking the ancient capital of Kyoto with Matsumoto. Today, Tsumago is loved for the residents' efforts to preserve the town's Edo Period ambiance. Power lines are hidden away and cars banned from the main roads during the daytime so that the beautiful, traditional buildings and flag-stone streets can be seen in their true glory. A visit to Tsumago is to step back in time and experience old Japan; a world away from the robots, gadgets and gizmos that many associate with modern Japanese cities. The walk along the old samurai trail from the neighbouring village of Magome through Tsumago and on to Nagiso is highly recommended.

Overnight at Daikichi • 1 x Twin Share (Incl. Breakfast & Dinner) - Japanese Without Bathroom

Day 9
Monday
09 Nov

Nakasendo Walk from Tsumago to Magome (8km, 3 Hours)

The best way to appreciate the Kiso Valley is to explore the region on foot, just as the samurai would have done. The villages of Tsumago and Magome sit on the Nakasendo Way, an ancient samurai pathway that traverses the lower Japanese Alps linking Kyoto and Matsumoto. Today the 3 hour walk between the two villages is well worth it for scenes of rural life, farmhouses and tea fields. The path is signposted in Japanese and English and is fairly gentle in terms of elevation. Full details of this hike will be in your Info-Pack including a rainy day alternative route by bus.

Magome - Introduction





Deep in the Kiso Valley, in the shadow of Mount Ena and overlooking a checkerboard of rice paddies, sits the historic village of Magome. This was once an important stop on the Nakasendo Way samurai trail and today retains beautiful wooden houses and a traditional, rural way of life. Like a pretty little hamlet in the Cotswolds, Magome is simply charming; the perfect place to potter around, take photos of quaint Japanese buildings, pop into craftshops and say konnichiwa to the friendly locals.

Bus from Magome to Nakatsugawa

From Magome you will need to take a local bus to Nakatsugawa train station. There are regular buses from Magome which are all signed in English and take around 30 minutes. We'll put the relevant bus times in your Info-Pack. Please pay on the day for the bus which costs 800 yen per person.

Trains From Nakatsugawa To Kyoto

From Nakatsugawa you will take a Ltd Exp train to Nagoya, where you will change to the Shinkansen bullet train to Kyoto. The journey will take around 2 hours in total.
Ordinary - Train Ticket (2)

Kyoto - Introduction





Kyoto is one of the most culturally rich cities in Asia. Home to 17 UNESCO World Heritage sites, over 1,600 Buddhist temples and 400 Shinto shrines, this ancient city showcases the heart and soul of traditional Japan. Kyoto boasts an array of world-class gardens, majestic festivals and delicate cuisine, all of which make much of the rhythms of nature and the changing of the seasons. On first glance however, visitors will see that like any large Japanese city, grid-like Kyoto has its fair share of neon and concrete. But the discerning eye will soon pick out Kyoto's treasures: sacred shrines tucked in among shopping arcades, time-honoured teahouses nestling among modern businesses and mysterious geisha scuttling down backstreets among the tourists and souvenirs. Kyoto's charm lies in these details and whether you're here for three days or three years, the closer you look, the more you'll discover.

Overnight at Solaria Nishitetsu Hotel Kyoto Premier • 1 x Double (25.5sqm) - Incl. B'fast

Day 10

Tuesday
10 Nov

Full Day Private Guide Service in Kyoto

Today you will have the services of a local professional guide for a private tour of Kyoto. Our guides speak English and have a wealth of knowledge to share. With the guide's expert help, you'll get to grips with Japanese culture and history while gaining a useful orientation of the city.

Your guide will meet you at your hotel at 9:00 AM (or any time you choose). Together you'll travel around on foot and by public transport. Please note you will need to pay for lunch and any entrance fees on the day. Your day of guiding will finish at 5:00 PM with the guide either dropping you back at your hotel or anywhere else in the city you wish to spend the rest of the day.

Private Guide Service - Classic Itinerary No Inclusions

Overnight at Solaria Nishitetsu Hotel Kyoto Premier • 1 x Double (25.5sqm) - Incl. B'fast

Day 11
Wednesday
11 Nov

Arts and Crafts in Kyoto

As the ancient centre of Japanese culture, it goes without saying that Kyoto is home to a wealth of traditional arts and crafts. Whether you want to see, learn about or purchase crafts, Kyoto has you covered. Here is a non-exhaustive list of our recommendations for different crafts in the city – check out your personalized Info-Pack for more information about access and opening times.

For an excellent overview of Kyoto crafts, we recommend heading to the Kyoto Museum of Crafts and Design, which houses exhibitions of every craft imaginable in a bright and modern building. There are explanations in English by all of the displays so you can learn about the production process and history of these traditional crafts. Depending on when you visit, you might be able to view live demonstrations by experienced artisans. The museum is located south of the Heian Shrine, near the National Museum of Modern Art.

If you're pressed for time, the best one-stop shop for all things arts and crafts is the Kyoto Handicraft Centre. Located slightly out of the way north of the Heian Shrine, it's well worth a visit and offers everything from inexpensive dolls and prints up to high-end lacquerware and antiques, making it a great place to pick up last minute souvenirs or a treat for yourself.

For fabric enthusiasts, there are several great places to visit. The Nishijin district is the centre of weaving in the city, and it's where gorgeous silk has been produced for centuries. At the Nishijin Textile Centre you can view the exquisite silk products and kimonos, and for an additional fee even try your hand at weaving yourself.

About a 12 minute walk away from the Textile Centre is the Orinasukan Handmade Fabric Museum. This small museum has information about the history of textiles in Kyoto, as well as displays of fabric and kimono. Everything is in Japanese but an English pamphlet is available.
Also in the Nishijin textiles district is the Aizen Kobo Indigo Dyeing Workshop, located in a 130 year old traditional building. You can learn about the natural, traditional indigo dyeing process from the artisans and peruse the one-of-a-kind items available for sale – be warned, they come with a high price tag!

If Japanese prints are more your thing, you might enjoy a visit to the Ukiyo-e Woodblock Prints Gallery Gado. Opened by a woodblock print artist, this small gallery showcases his own work (so you won't find the famous ukiyo-e prints by Hokusai and other masters), but it's still interesting to see a modern ukiyo-e artist at work. The gallery is near Kinkakuji, the Golden Temple.



Overnight at Solaria Nishitetsu Hotel Kyoto Premier • 1 x Double (25.5sqm) - Incl. B'fast

Day 12
Thursday
12 Nov

Suggested Sightseeing - Alternative Arashiyama

You may have heard of the western district of Kyoto known as Arashiyama (lit. 'storm mountain'), famed for the iconic Sagano Arashiyama bamboo grove that many Kyoto visitors flock to – estimated to have around 15 million visitors a year.

However, there is more to this part of the city than this grove. We prefer a quieter vibe; we like to take a walk through the north of the area for a more pleasant experience that will introduce you to some lesser-known favourites. Passing temples and shrines that inspired literary masterpieces such as 'The Tale of Genji', you'll have the opportunity to see various different aspects of Kyoto culture, history and Buddhist philosophy. You can also see a smaller but much more serene bamboo forest at Adashino-nenbutsuji along the way.

This suggested sightseeing route will visit around 3-4 sites across the space of a half day; with around 1-2 hours' worth of walking involved overall; some involving upward inclines. Full details of sites we recommend and the route will be included with your Info Pack.



Overnight at Solaria Nishitetsu Hotel Kyoto Premier • 1 x Double (25.5sqm) - Incl. B'fast

Day 13
Friday
13 Nov

Optional Day Trip to Nara

Today you might like to take a day trip to Nara. Nara lies just 40 minutes by local train from Kyoto and is renowned for the wealth of its Buddhist and Shinto heritage. In 710 Nara became the first permanent capital of Japan and with this the large monasteries rapidly gained in political power and influence resulting in frequent bloodshed as the different sects fought for supremacy and power. Such was the rise of the monasteries that in 784 the capital was moved away from Nara in order to protect the position of the Emperor and the central government, eventually settling in Heian (Kyoto) in 794 where it remained for the next 1000 years.

Today Nara still boasts many striking landmarks that reflect its former power and influence. The shrines and temples open at 7 AM and early rising pilgrims and tourists will be rewarded with a peace and tranquillity which is perhaps lacking later in the day when the coach tours arrive. If gardens are more your thing, we recommend visiting Isuien Garden, the best strolling landscape garden in Nara, which provides stunning views of Mount Kasuga and Mount Wakakusa. After exploring the religious side of Nara, you can head into the city proper to explore Naramachi, the former merchant district; it's a pleasant place to experience a slice of Edo Period Japan.

Trains run regularly between Kyoto and Nara. You will need to pay on the day for train tickets which are 710 yen each way. You can also take time after your trip to Nara to stop in Uji or Fushimi Inari, as they're both served by the same train line - Fushimi Inari is a popular site and visiting at the end of the day can be a calmer, quieter experience.

Timetables and sightseeing suggestions for the day will of course be in your Info-Pack.

Nara - Introduction





Nara lies just 40 minutes by local train from Kyoto and is renowned for the wealth of its Buddhist and Shinto heritage. Nara was formerly the end of the Silk Road and was for this reason the area which first saw Buddhist teaching making the transition across the ocean from China. The daibutsu or big Buddha is hugely impressive as is the huge wooden structure which houses it, to this day the world's largest wooden building despite the current structure being a third smaller than the original. The myriad of shrines and temples are all set against the backdrop of the low lying mountains and in the midst of Nara Park, which is famously home to a vast population of pesky deer. Given half a chance they'll happily munch on your guide books, umbrellas, scarves, and about anything else they can get their noses into!

Overnight at Solaria Nishitetsu Hotel Kyoto Premier • 1 x Double (25.5sqm) - Incl. B'fast

Day 14
Saturday
14 Nov

Trains from Kyoto to Takamatsu

We will provide you with reserved seat tickets for the Shinkansen and a limited express train from Kyoto to Takamatsu. The journey will take 2 hours 15 minutes including an easy change in Okayama.

Ordinary - Train Ticket (2)

Takamatsu - Introduction





Takamatsu is the largest city in Kagawa Prefecture in the northeast corner of Shikoku Island. Takamatsu faces the Inland Sea and has a long history as a port, acting as something of a link between Shikoku and the main island of Honshu. The city's top attraction is Ritsurin Koen, one of Japan's finest examples of a landscape garden and considered by many to be on a par with the famous 'Big Three' gardens of Mito, Okayama and Kanazawa. Also of interest are Yashima, a flat-topped mountain and nearby Shikoku-Mura, a collection of traditional houses and other buildings brought from all over Shikoku to display local architecture and construction techniques.

Ritsurin Garden in Takamatsu

Today you have free time to explore Takamatsu at your own pace. One of our suggestions is a visit to the pride of Takamatsu: Ritsurin-koen, the largest garden in Japan. This huge strolling garden is situated at the foot of Mount Shiun and was built over an astonishing 100 years during the Edo Period by the feudal lords of the province. It features a Japanese style garden in the south and a western style one in the north, and was designed to provide enjoyment during all seasons and from all angles. The colourful flowers, rich greenery, intricate water features and elegant tea houses add up to a real Japanese experience.

It will take you around 1 to 2 hours to fully explore the park. Scattered around you will find various facilities including a small folk museum, little shops, and some rest houses where you can take a breather and enjoy the views of the garden. Kikugetsu-tei teahouse in the southwest area of the garden is particularly lovely, and for a small fee you can refresh with a cup of green tea while sitting on the tatami mat floors.

Ritsurin Koen is roughly 2 km south of JR Takamatsu Station. You can either take the Kotoden Kotohira Line from Takamatsu-Chikko Station to Ritsurinkoen Station (around 7 minutes and 190 yen), or a JR train from Takamatsu Station to Ritsurinkoen-Kitaguchi (5 minutes and 210 yen). From either station it’s a 5 – 10 minute walk to the entrance to the garden. If you have a look in your Info-Pack you’ll find more detailed information and maps of how to access Ritsurin Koen so that you get the most out of your day. Admission is 410yen.

Overnight at Royal Park Hotel Takamatsu • 1 x Double - Incl. Breakfast

Day 15
Sunday
15 Nov

Ferry from Takamatsu to Naoshima (Miyanoura Port)

From Takamatsu Port you will take a Shikoku Kisen Ferry to Miyanoura Port on Naoshima. The crossing takes about 50 minutes and is a scenic ride with some great views of the myriad islands of the inland sea. Tickets cost 520 yen and will need to be bought on the day.

Naoshima - Introduction





Naoshima could easily be another pretty, but forgotten island in the Seto Inland Sea scraping a living from fishing. However a unique art project has given Naoshima its deserved global reputation. Naoshima is home to a large collection of contemporary art galleries, exhibits and installations which offer a tour de force of architectural expression integrating art and the natural environment. Two of the main galleries, the Chichu Art Museum and Benesse House, were designed by the world famous architect Tadao Ando and feature works by Claude Monet, Walter de Maria, James Turrell, Andy Warhol, Richard Long and Bruce Nauman among others.

Distances between the main art sites are small and the picturesque island can be explored on foot or by bike. Bicycles are available to hire at Miyanoura Port.

Bike Rental on Naoshima (reservation only)

Cycling is our favourite way to discover Naoshima! We will make a bike reservation for you, and then you'll be able to pick it up on the day. We'll reserve an electric bike for you, which will cost 1,500 yen per day. Hills will be a breeze thanks to the electric power mode!. Full details will be provided in your Info-Pack.

Electric Bike (26 Inch) - Private Service (2)

Sightseeing on Naoshima

Today you have a day at leisure to explore all the wonderful art sights on Naoshima at your own pace. Buses on the island are fairly infrequent, so we recommend renting a bike from Miyanoura ferry terminal to get around (although there are some steep hills at the Benesse House end of the island!). At the end of a busy day sightseeing, don't miss an onsen bath at the kitschy I Love Yuu bath house in Miyanoura.

Chichu Art Museum

We will provide tickets for you for the Chichu Art Museum, one of the most highly regarded art sites on Naoshima. The Chichu Art Museum was designed by the celebrated architect Tadao Ando in 2004. Ando's intention was to seamlessly marry beautiful design with Naoshima's natural surroundings, and most of the museum is built underground in order to avoid disrupting the scenery.

Despite its subterranean position, the Chichu is famous for its innovative use of light: the galleries are designed so that the paintings are illuminated by natural daylight, their surfaces rippling with the changing weather and appearing utterly transformed at different times of day. Nowhere is the effect more striking than with Claude Monet's Water Lilies, five of which hang permanently at the Chichu and never fail to make a deep impression on visitors.
Entrance Fee - Ticket

Ferry from Naoshima (Miyanoura Port) to Takamatsu

From Miyanoura Port on Naoshima Island you will take a Shikoku Kisen Ferry to Takamatsu Port today. The crossing takes about 60 minutes and is a scenic ride with some great views of the myriad islands of the inland sea. Tickets cost 520 yen and will need to be bought on the day.



Overnight at Royal Park Hotel Takamatsu • 1 x Double - Incl. Breakfast

Day 16
Monday
16 Nov

Ferry from Takamatsu to Teshima (Ieura Port)

Today you might like to make a trip to Teshima Island. There are high speed ferries from Takamatsu to Ieura Port on Teshima. The journey takes 35 minutes and you will need to pay 1,330 yen on the day for the ferry ticket. Full instructions including ferry times will be in your Info-Pack.

Teshima - Introduction





Along with Naoshima and Inujima, the little island of Teshima in the Seto Inland Sea is now an exciting destination for contemporary art. The main draw is the Teshima Art Museum - more an open-air sculpture than a museum, a concrete structure emerging from the rice paddies where light, water and nature converge in an intriguing fashion. Other artworks are dotted around the island's three fishing villages (total population under 1,000). Electric bike is the best way to get around - easy to rent from the Teshima Art Museum. Allow half to a full day to explore Teshima.

Teshima Art Museum

Today we will arrange tickets for you to visit Teshima Art Museum. This is the must-see attraction on Teshima island. More an open-air sculpture than a museum, the concrete structure of Teshima Art Museum emerges from the rice paddies where light, water and nature converge in an intriguing fashion. The building is designed to represent a droplet of water on a surface. The museum also has its own cafe - a work of art in itself. Your tickets will be for a timed entry slot to the museum.
Entrance Ticket - Ticket

Sightseeing on Teshima

Today you have time to explore the island of Teshima--we suggest allowing a half or full day to see all it has to offer. Along with neighbouring Naoshima and Inujima, the little island of Teshima (total population under 1,000) in the Seto Inland Sea is now an exciting destination for contemporary art. The main draw is the Teshima Art Museum, but there are also other artworks dotted around the island's three fishing villages: Ieura, Karato, and Kou. Electric bike is the best way to get around - easy to rent from the Teshima Art Museum or near the ports – and there are also shuttle buses running around the island.

Ferry from Teshima (Ieura Port) to Takamatsu

The ferry journey from Teshima back to Takamatsu takes 35 minutes. You will need to pay on the day for the ferry ticket. Full instructions including ferry times will be in your Info-Pack.



Overnight at Royal Park Hotel Takamatsu • 1 x Double - Incl. Breakfast

Day 17
Tuesday
17 Nov

Trains from Takamatsu to Tokyo

Today you'll take the trains from Takamatsu to Tokyo, with a change at Okayama. Journey time is about 4 hours and 30 minutes.
Train Ticket - Ordinary (2)

Local train journey in Tokyo

You will take a local train journey across Tokyo from Tokyo to Asakusa.



Overnight at Asakusa View Hotel Annex Rokku • 1 x Standard Queen (29sqm) - Incl. Breakfast

Day 18
Wednesday
18 Nov

Sightseeing in Tokyo

You have a final free day in Tokyo, a chance to see anything you may have missed at the start of your trip. This is also a good opportunity for last minute shopping and a great final night among the bright neon lights!



Overnight at Asakusa View Hotel Annex Rokku • 1 x Standard Queen (29sqm) - Incl. Breakfast

Day 19
Thursday
19 Nov

Shared Shuttle Bus from Hotel to Tokyo Haneda Airport

Sadly your time in Japan must come to an end. You will transfer by shuttle bus today to Tokyo Haneda Airport. The driver will wait for you in the lobby of the hotel with a sign with your name on it. Please note that as other people will be travelling on the same bus there may be a few pick-ups in Tokyo before you head to the airport (maximum of 3 other stops). Journey time is around 1 hour and this is a comfortable and easy way to make today's transfer. We hope you have a safe flight home.
Seat - Shared Service (2)

Flight BA6 from Haneda Airport to London Heathrow Dep. 13:15 Arr. 19:10

Depart Haneda Airport on flight BA6 to London Heathrow. The flight departs at 13:15 and arrives at 19:10.

Accommodation

Tokyo

Mitsui Garden Hotel Jingugaien Tokyo Premier — Superior

Matsumoto

Matsumoto Hotel Kagetsu — Moderate

The Hotel Kagetsu has been a part of the fabric of Matsumoto for over a hundred years. The location is perfect; just a short walk from Matsumoto castle, and the hotel retains an authentic Meiji-era atmosphere with lots of folk-craft furniture. The restaurant and cafe are very good - the Japanese style breakfast is one of our favourites in Japan - it's enormous! The hotel has its own bath house as well as fully en-suite rooms.



Narai

Echigoya — Moderate

Tonight you will stay in the beautiful Echigoya, a 200 year old ryokan that is the only inn in Narai to have operated continuously since the Edo Period. The wooden building has a lattice work front, paper lanterns and sliding doors ushering in a nostalgic atmosphere of yesteryear. There are just two tatami mat guestrooms and a maximum of 6 guests are accepted each night. As you would expect from such an old building, rooms are not en-suite, but there is a shared bathroom that can be used in turn. Please note that staff do not speak much English, but will offer heartfelt hospitality. Both breakfast and dinner are included; traditional multi-course meals with local vegetables and river fish.

Tsumago

Daikichi

Moderate

In Tsumago you will spend 1 at the Daikichi which has appeared on TV Tokyo's Top Ten Minshuku programme and been patronised by many celebrities. This is an authentic old style minshuku (small family-run traditional accommodation) known for its warm welcome and local cuisine. Look out for the fried grasshoppers! The minshuku has just five guest rooms. Rooms are not en-suite but there is a shared bath which can be used privately.



Kyoto

Solaria Nishitetsu Hotel Kyoto Premier

Superior

Solaria Nishitetsu Premier is a fantastic base for exploring Kyoto. The location is unbeatable - in the heart of Kyoto's downtown area full of restaurants and shops, and with lovely views over the Kamo River. Rooms start at 25sqm and are stylish and modern with en-suite bathrooms. The hotel also has public Japanese-style baths overlooking the river. WiFi is free throughout the building and the hotel has its own restaurant.



Takamatsu

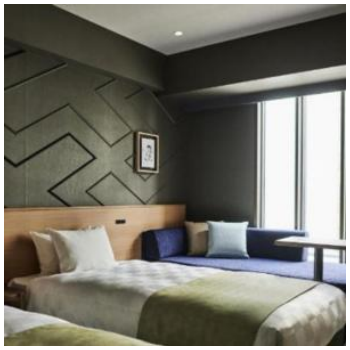
Royal Park Hotel Takamatsu

Moderate

Tokyo

Asakusa View Hotel Annex Rokku

Superior



A stone's throw away from Senso-ji temple - the heart of Asakusa - the Asakusa View Hotel Annex Rokku is a great base for sightseeing in the local area and Tokyo in general. Not only are you minutes from the iconic temple and its impressive Kaminarimon gate, you're well connected too with subway and train line connections nearby. The property is surrounded by restaurants serving a variety of cuisine, so you're never far from whatever you fancy. The hotel has its own lounge on the top floor, providing views across the Asakusa district towards the imposing Skytree across the river. If you're interested in traditional Japanese artistry, look out for the murals across the hotel nodding to Japanese traditional theatre like Noh and Kabuki.

Visa Information

Japan

Visitors with passports from the majority of destinations (including Europe, Australia, New Zealand and North America) do not need visas to tourist travel to Japan for less than 90 days.

What's included

Our cultural adventures include hotels, guides, transport, and experiences carefully curated by our passionate specialists to give you a memorable trip which has a positive impact on the destinations we love. Below you can find a breakdown of everything we've included. If something you are expecting to see is not listed below, get in touch.

Not included

- Meals not listed in the inclusions
- Local transport (such as IC cards, taxis, bus etc.) unless otherwise specified
- Luggage forwarding/handling unless otherwise specified
- Entrance fees, unless otherwise specified
- Visas (if required)
- Tips to local drivers/guides
- Any optional experiences or excursions not specified
- Travel Insurance *(a requirement for travelling with us)*



International Flights

Flight date	Flight details
Sun 01 Nov 2026	British Airways flight BA5, dep. London (LHR) at. 11:45, arr. Tokyo (HND) at. 10:25 + 1 2 x ADL - Economy
Thu 19 Nov 2026	British Airways flight BA6, dep. Tokyo (HND) at. 13:15, arr. London (LHR) at. 19:10 2 x ADL - Economy



Accommodation

Check-in date	Nights	Location	Property & room details
Mon 02 Nov 2026	4	TOKYO	Mitsui Garden Hotel Jingugaien Tokyo Premier 1 x Double - Incl. Breakfast
Fri 06 Nov 2026	1	MATSUMOTO	Matsumoto Hotel Kagetsu 1 x Standard Twin (Main Building) (24sqm) - Incl. B'fast
Sat 07 Nov 2026	1	NARAI	Echigoya 1 x Twin Use (Japanese Style) - Without Bathroom (Incl. Breakfast & Dinner)
Sun 08 Nov 2026	1	TSUMAGO	Daikichi 1 x Twin Share (Incl. Breakfast & Dinner) - Japanese Without Bathroom
Mon 09 Nov 2026	5	KYOTO	Solaria Nishitetsu Hotel Kyoto Premier 1 x Double (25.5sqm) - Incl. B'fast
Sat 14 Nov 2026	3	TAKAMATSU	Royal Park Hotel Takamatsu 1 x Double - Incl. Breakfast

Tue 17 Nov 2026	2	TOKYO	Asakusa View Hotel Annex Rokku 1 x Standard Queen (29sqm) - Incl. Breakfast



Ground Transportation

Date of service	Location	Service
Mon 02 Nov 2026	TOKYO	Shared Shuttle Bus from Haneda Airport to Tokyo Hotel 2 x Seat - Shared Service
Mon 02 Nov 2026	TOKYO	Mobile WiFi Device 1 x 18 Day Rental (Incl. Delivery & Full Insurance) - Softbank (unlimited data)
Fri 06 Nov 2026	TOKYO	Train: Tokyo (Shinjuku) to Matsumoto 2 x ADL, Limited Express - Ordinary
Sat 07 Nov 2026	MATSUMOTO	Train: Matsumoto to Yabuhara 2 x ADL, Fare Ticket - Ordinary
Sun 08 Nov 2026	NARAI	Train: Narai to Nagiso 2 x ADL, Fare Ticket - Ordinary
Mon 09 Nov 2026	NAKATSUGAWA	Train: Nakatsugawa to Kyoto 2 x ADL, Fare Ticket - Joushaken
Mon 09 Nov 2026	NAKATSUGAWA	Train: Nakatsugawa to Nagoya 2 x ADL, Limited Express - Ordinary
Mon 09 Nov 2026	NAGOYA	Train: Nagoya to Kyoto 2 x ADL, Nozomi Super Express - Ordinary
Sat 14 Nov 2026	KYOTO	Train: Kyoto to Takamatsu 2 x ADL, Fare Ticket - Joushaken
Sat 14 Nov 2026	KYOTO	Train: Kyoto to Okayama 2 x ADL, Nozomi Super Express - Ordinary
Sat 14 Nov 2026	OKAYAMA	Train: Okayama to Takamatsu 2 x ADL, Limited Express - Ordinary
Tue 17 Nov 2026	TAKAMATSU	Train: Takamatsu to Tokyo 2 x ADL, Fare Ticket - Ordinary
Tue 17 Nov 2026	TAKAMATSU	Train: Takamatsu to Okayama 2 x ADL, Limited Express - Ordinary
Tue 17 Nov 2026	OKAYAMA	Train: Okayama to Tokyo 2 x ADL, Shinkansen Super Express - Ordinary
Thu 19 Nov 2026	TOKYO	Shared Shuttle Bus from Hotel to Tokyo Haneda Airport 2 x Seat - Shared Service

Excursions, experiences, & guides

Date of service	Location	Service
Tue 10 Nov 2026	KYOTO	Full Day Private Guide Service in Kyoto Private Guide Service - Classic Itinerary
Sun 15 Nov 2026	NAOSHIMA	Bike Rental on Naoshima (reservation only) Electric Bike (26 Inch) - Private Service
Sun 15 Nov 2026	NAOSHIMA	Chichu Art Museum Entrance Fee - Ticket
Mon 16 Nov 2026	TESHIMA	Teshima Art Museum Entrance Ticket - Ticket

Baggage Handling and Luggage Forwarding

Most trips rely on Japan's excellent rail network to get around the country. Don't want to worry about carrying large luggage with you? We highly recommend taking advantage of *takuhaibin*, Japan's fantastic luggage forwarding service. For around 2,500yen (about the same cost as a meal), you can forward a bag next day between pretty much any two points. We'll include suggestions of when to make use of it in your Info-Pack to make your travel as stress free as possible.



IC Transport Cards

We recommend purchasing IC Transport Cards to use on local public transport in Japan. IC cards are easy and efficient to use, can be topped up as necessary, and are valid on most public transport across the country. You can buy IC cards at major stations across Japan, or a digital version is available for iPhone users. We'll include details on purchasing and using IC cards in your Info-Pack.

Accommodation Tax in Japan

Some Japanese cities charge a small accommodation tax (also known as city tax) to hotel guests. Wherever possible, we arrange for this to be covered in advance but on occasion, it is not possible for us to do so and you will be asked to pay at check-in. The cost should come to no more than a few

hundred yen per person. In Kyoto the city tax amounts are higher but will have been included for you unless specified below.

Visiting Naoshima

To get the most out of a visit to Naoshima and neighbouring islands, we recommend checking museum opening days and events on during your stay well in advance. For example, James Turrell Open Sky Programme (Fridays and Saturdays) and Kinza Art House Project (Monday to Wednesday) **must be booked in advance**.

We can book tickets for the popular **Chichu Art Museum** and **Teshima Art Museum** in advance so please let us know if you plan to include them, if they are not already included in your itinerary.

For other museums, please visit the Benesse Art Site Museum website in advance and plan your day from there – tickets will usually go on sale around 1-2 months prior to the visit, so we recommend scheduling a time to book any of your must-see museums.
Link: https://benesse-artsite.jp/en/general-information.html



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